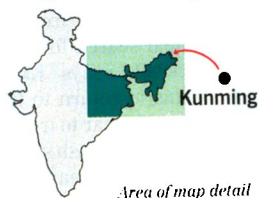




KNOWN CRASH SITES

- 1 C-46: Hill north of Itanagar
- 2 C-47: Near Minzong village, south of Walong
- 3 C-46: Near Mangung village, south of Walong
- 4 C-109: Bhishmaknagar village near Pasighat
- 5 B-24J: Near Damrah village, Upper Siang district
- 6 C-47: Near Walong
- 7 C-87: Near Latti village, south of Walong



Indian Army personnel and state government officials on the ground. Over 78,000 Americans are still missing from World War II, 1,632 of them from the China/Burma/India theatre. "We believe that approximately 430 of those service members are located within India," Major Brian DeSantis, JPAC spokesperson told INDIA TODAY.

The JPAC does about 70 recovery missions a year from battlefields spread across the world—Vietnam, Cambodia, South Korea and Germany. The US has however never launched a recovery operation in India for over 60 years. A policy which will change this year, though it will take several years to account for all the missing 430 US personnel.

A team of US specialists led by Rear Admiral Donna L. Crisp, commander, JPAC is to meet Indian Defence Ministry officials in March to discuss specific plans for further investigations and recovery operations. IAF helicopters flying out of Assam have already begun preliminary work in identifying crash sites and helipads for the operations which are slated to begin between April and May this year.

"India is definitely one of the countries where we would like to initiate and maintain investigation and recovery efforts in order to complete the accounting of missing service members from World War II. We are hopeful that these meetings will lead to further US-India cooperation on this important humanitarian endeavour," says Major DeSantis.

During the war the Allied forces lost hundreds of aircraft, mainly transport aircraft and bombers (see graphic) in what was known as the China-Burma-India theatre while flying over "the hump" missions. A majority of the crashes were caused by mechanical failures, adverse weather or navigational errors. Aircraft crashed most often killing all their crews, the crash site being cut off due to inhospitable terrain in India's remote North-east.

The US has made efforts at recovering the remains of its MIA's, yet the saga of the Hot as Hell is an inspiring account of private citizens lobbying governments to recover the remains of their relatives missing for over half a

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